STUDY AID · MATTHEW 27 · EPISODE 54 (#57 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

How to *Die Well*

He showed them how to die

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 27 in the LSB | 39:25 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: The Forgotten Lesson of the Cross. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads all of Matthew 27. Jesus is delivered to Pilate. Judas, remorseful, returns the thirty pieces of silver, throws them into the sanctuary and hangs himself; the chief priests buy the Potter's Field. Jesus is silent before Pilate. The crowd, persuaded by the chief priests and elders, chooses Barabbas; Pilate washes his hands; 'His blood be on us and on our children!' Jesus is scourged, mocked, and crucified at Golgotha between two robbers. Darkness falls; He cries, 'My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?' and yields up His spirit. The veil is torn, the earth shakes, saints are raised, and the centurion confesses Him. Joseph of Arimathea buries Him, and the tomb is sealed and guarded.
- Observations: Matthew follows the blood money to show fulfillment of Jeremiah. A commentator notes a triad who shed innocent blood: Judas (27:4), Pilate (27:24) and the crowd led by its leaders (27:25). 'You yourself say it' means 'that's your way of putting it.' Some manuscripts call Barabbas 'Jesus Barabbas'; his name means 'son of a father.' The crowd's words fit Jesus' teaching on 'this evil generation' (12:45; 23:36) and give no warrant for blaming all Jews for all time.
- Jesus refuses the wine mixed with gall (myrrh in Mark 15:23). His cry is a hint pointing hearers to all of Psalm 22: He is still teaching as He dies. The video is honest about open questions: which veil was torn, and how to read the raised saints.

> *"Dying is the final act of obedience that a person can perform unto God. And the one who is filled with the word of God will glorify God in their final act of obedience.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Jesus didn't just die for his followers. He showed them how to die.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- Connections: Deuteronomy 23:18 and the temple treasury; Zechariah 11:12-13 and Exodus 21:32; Jeremiah 19:1-13; Isaiah 53:7 and 53:9; Leviticus 20:9; Matthew 20:18-19; Proverbs 31:6; Psalm 69:21; Psalm 22; Joel 2:10; 1 Peter 2:24.
- The lesson: dying is the final act of obedience that a person can perform unto God, and the one who is filled with the word of God will glorify God in their final act of obedience.

Read the whole psalm

When the New Testament quotes one line of a psalm, read the whole psalm. Read Psalm 22 beside Matthew 27 and mark each match.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 54 of the Matthew study (playlist item 57).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 27 and turns to Mark 15, Luke 23, John 19, Deuteronomy 23, Zechariah 11, Exodus 21, Jeremiah 19, Isaiah 53, Leviticus 20, Matthew 20, Proverbs 31, Psalms 22 and 69, Joel 2, 1 Peter 2 and Romans 8. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 27:1-66
Read in full.

Mark 15:21-47
Mark's account of the cross and burial.

Luke 23:26-56
Luke's account.

John 19:16-42
John's account: 'It is finished!'

Deuteronomy 23:18
Not into the house of Yahweh.

Zechariah 11:12-13
Thirty shekels thrown to the potter.

Exodus 21:32
The price of a slave.

Jeremiah 19:1-13
The potter's jar and innocent blood.

Isaiah 53:7-9
Silent, and with a rich man in His death.

Leviticus 20:9
His bloodguiltiness is upon him.

Matthew 20:18-19
Jesus foretells the mocking.

Proverbs 31:6
Wine to those whose soul is bitter.

Psalm 69:21
Gall and vinegar.

Psalm 22:1-31
My God, my God.

Joel 2:10
The sun and the moon grow dark.

1 Peter 2:24
He bore our sins in His body.

Romans 8:2
Set free from the law of sin and of death.

Key verses in the LSB

"And Jesus cried out again with a loud voice, and yielded up His spirit."
Matthew 27:50 (LSB)

"For He has not despised and He has not abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; / And He has not hidden His face from him; / But when he cried to Him for help, He heard."
Psalm 22:24 (LSB)

"Who Himself bore our sins in His body on the tree, so that having died to sin, we might live to righteousness; by His wounds you were healed."
1 Peter 2:24 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The silver

Judas, the blood money and the Potter's Field.

MATTHEW 27:3-8; DEUTERONOMY 23:18

The price of blood

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 27:5-6
"And he threw the pieces of silver into the sanctuary and departed; and he went away and hanged himself. And the chief priests took the pieces of silver and said, "It is not lawful to put them into the temple treasury, since it is the price of blood.""

MOSES · DEUTERONOMY 23:18
"You shall not bring the hire of a harlot or the wages of a dog into the house of Yahweh your God for any votive offering, for both of these are an abomination to Yahweh your God."

FROM THE VIDEO 'I have sinned by betraying innocent blood' (27:4): a plea, a confession, or both? We are not told.

FROM THE VIDEO The leaders will not put blood money in the treasury, yet carry out the plot that produced it: an odd duality of wickedness and ceremony, close to Jesus' teaching on hypocrisy.

◆ Factbook: Judas Iscariot ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Book of Deuteronomy

MATTHEW 27:9-10; ZECHARIAH 11:12-13

Thrown to the potter

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 27:9-10

“Then that which was spoken through Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled, saying, “And they took the thirty pieces of silver, the price of the one whose price had been set by the sons of Israel; and they gave them for the Potter’s Field, as the Lord directed me.””

ZECHARIAH · ZECHARIAH 11:13

“Then Yahweh said to me, “Throw it to the potter, that valuable price at which I was valued by them.” So I took the thirty shekels of silver and threw them to the potter in the house of Yahweh.”

FROM THE VIDEO Judas throws the silver into the sanctuary because, even in betrayal, he knows his Scripture. Thirty shekels was the price of a slave (Exodus 21:32): an insult. Exodus 21:32

FROM THE VIDEO Matthew names Jeremiah; the video suggests Jeremiah 19:1-13, with the potter's jar and the blood of the innocent. Jeremiah 19:1-13

◆ Factbook: Zechariah (father of John the Baptist) ◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: The Exodus

> *“We never outgrow these teachings, ladies and gentlemen. We only grow further and further into them.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Before Pilate

Silence, Barabbas, and 'His blood be on us.'

MATTHEW 27:11-14; ISAIAH 53:7

You yourself say it

MATTHEW 27:11-12 (LSB)

SILENT AGAIN

“Now Jesus stood before the governor, and the governor questioned Him, saying, “Are You the King of the Jews?” And Jesus said to him, “You yourself say it.” And while He was being accused by the chief priests and elders, He did not answer.”

FROM THE VIDEO A commentator reads 'You yourself say it' as 'that's your way of putting it.' Jesus is King and Son of God, but not as Pilate or Caiaphas understand it; He rejects their framing while answering yes.

FROM THE VIDEO His silence again fulfills Isaiah 53:7, as before the chief priests. Isaiah 53:7

◆ Factbook: Messiah

MATTHEW 27:15-26

Barabbas or Jesus?

MATTHEW 27:24-25 (LSB)

SON OF A FATHER

“Now when Pilate saw that he was accomplishing nothing, but rather that a riot was starting, he took water and washed his hands in front of the crowd, saying, “I am innocent of this man’s blood; see to that yourselves.” And all the people answered and said, “His blood be on us and on our children!””

FROM THE VIDEO Pilate knew it was envy (27:18). The chief priests and elders persuaded the crowds (27:20). Barabbas means 'son of a father'; Mark says he was held with insurrectionists (Mark 15:7). Son of a father against the Son of the heavenly Father. Mark 15:7

FROM THE VIDEO 'His blood be on us' echoes the law's phrase 'His bloodguiltiness is upon him' (Leviticus 20:9): taking full responsibility. Many see it fulfilled in AD 70, but no one should see a curse on all Jews for all time; it concerns 'this evil generation' (12:45; 23:36).

Leviticus 20:9 Matthew 12:45 Matthew 23:36

◆ Factbook: Gentiles



Pilate washed his hands in front of the crowd

Antonio Ciseri, Ecce Homo, 1871. Galleria d'arte moderna, Florence, via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“Jesus didn't just die for his followers. He showed them how to die.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The cross

Psalm 22, the cry, the veil and the tomb.

MATTHEW 27:34-43; PSALM 22

They cast lots

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 27:35

“And when they had crucified Him, they divided up His garments among themselves by casting lots.”

DAVID · PSALM 22:18

“They divide my garments among them, / And for my clothing they cast lots.”

FROM THE VIDEO The wine mixed with gall is bitter myrrh (Mark 15:23), which would have dulled the pain; He would not drink. The custom may rest on Proverbs 31:6; Matthew may also see Psalm 69:21. Mark 15:23 Proverbs 31:6 Psalm 69:21

FROM THE VIDEO The mockers' 'He trusts in God; let God rescue Him' matches Psalm 22:7-8. Jesus had told the disciples all of this in advance (20:18-19). Psalm 22:7-8 Matthew 20:18-19

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: David



MATTHEW 27:45-50

My God, My God

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 27:46

“And about the ninth hour Jesus cried out with a loud voice, saying, “Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani?” that is, “My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?””

DAVID · PSALM 22:27

“All the ends of the earth will remember and turn to Yahweh, / And all the families of the nations will worship before You.”

FROM THE VIDEO The cry is a remez, a hint that sends hearers to the whole psalm, which ends in victory: 'He has done it' (Psalm 22:31). In His death Jesus is still teaching. Compare His last word in John: 'It is finished!' (John 19:30). Psalm 22:31 John 19:30

FROM THE VIDEO The darkness recalls Joel 2:10, just before the promise of the Spirit that Peter quotes at Pentecost (Acts 2). Joel 2:10

◆ Factbook: Elijah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Joel (the prophet) ◆ Factbook: Pentecost



MATTHEW 27:51-61; ISAIAH 53:9

The veil, the tombs, the grave

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 27:51

“And behold, the veil of the sanctuary was torn in two from top to bottom; and the earth shook and the rocks were split.”

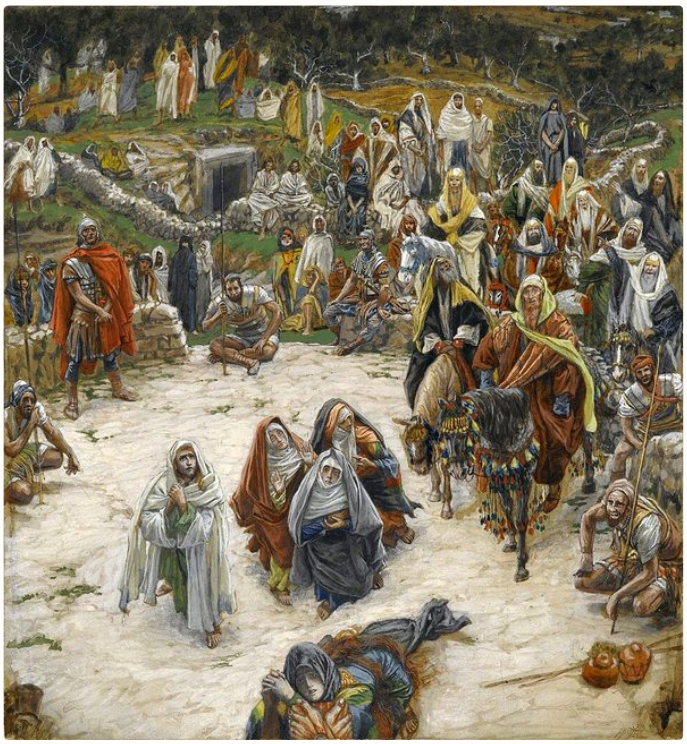
ISAIAH · ISAIAH 53:9

“So His grave was assigned with wicked men, / Yet He was with a rich man in His death, / Because He had done no violence, / Nor was there any deceit in His mouth.”

FROM THE VIDEO Which veil? One divided the holy place from the holy of holies, another the holy place from the courts. Either spells doom for the temple; Jesus Himself is the true temple. The video leaves the raised saints (27:52-53) as an open question.

FROM THE VIDEO The earthquake echoes 1 Kings 19:11, Isaiah 29:6, Jeremiah 10:10 and Ezekiel 26:18. Joseph, a rich man, buries Him (Isaiah 53:9). 1 Kings 19:11 Isaiah 29:6

◆ Factbook: Centurion ◆ Factbook: Resurrection ◆ Factbook: Isaiah



My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?

James Tissot, What Our Saviour Saw from the Cross, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *God does not forsake his own. He did not forsake Jesus and he will not forsake his people.*
>
> From the video

06

Who's who in Matthew 27

What the video says, then a short background note.

Pilate

VIDEO Knows it is envy, washes his hands: one of the triad who shed innocent blood.

BACKGROUND Roman prefect of Judea, AD 26-36.

Matthew 27:18 · Matthew 27:24 · ◆ Pontius Pilate

Barabbas

VIDEO A notorious prisoner, probably a zealot; 'son of a father.'

BACKGROUND Some manuscripts of 27:16-17 call him Jesus Barabbas.

Matthew 27:16-17 · Mark 15:7 · ◆ Barabbas

Judas

VIDEO Remorseful, returns the silver, throws it into the sanctuary.

Simon of Cyrene

VIDEO Pressed into service to bear the cross.

BACKGROUND Mark names his sons, Alexander and Rufus (Mark 15:21).

BACKGROUND Acts 1:18-19 gives another account of his death and the Field of Blood.

Matthew 27:3-5 | Acts 1:18-19 | ◆ Judas Iscariot

Matthew 27:32 | Mark 15:21 | ◆ Simon of Cyrene

The centurion

VIDEO Sees the earthquake and confesses, 'Truly this was God's Son!'

BACKGROUND A Roman officer over about a hundred soldiers.

Matthew 27:54 | ◆ Centurion

Joseph of Arimathea

VIDEO A rich man and disciple who buries Jesus in his own new tomb.

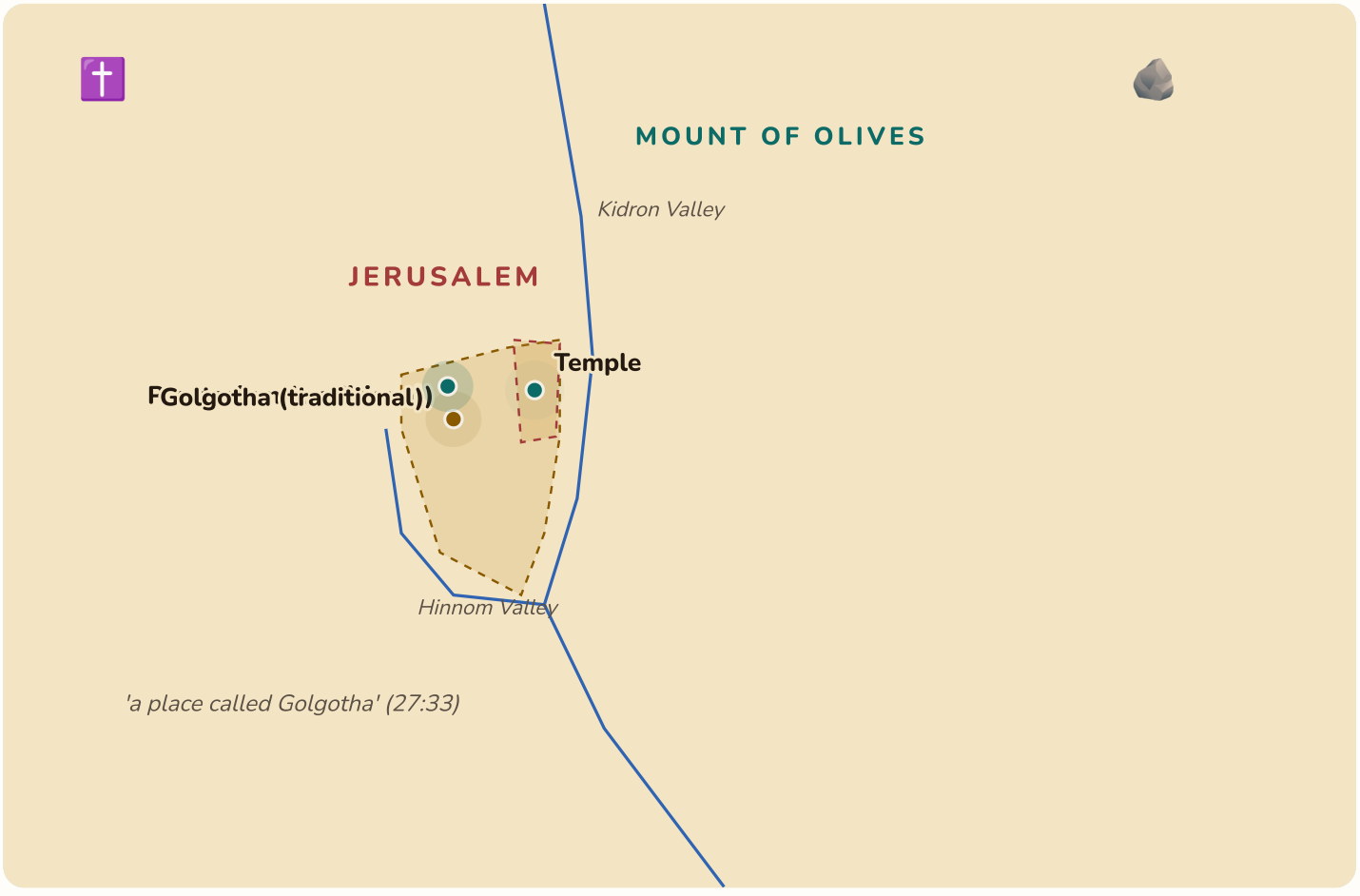
BACKGROUND A member of the council (Mark 15:43).

Matthew 27:57-60 | Mark 15:43 | ◆ Joseph of Arimathea

07 · BACKGROUND

From the Praetorium to the tomb

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century. Traditional sites are marked as traditional.

Temple VIDEO

Judas 'threw the pieces of silver into the sanctuary' (27:5).

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish)

Praetorium (traditional) BACKGROUND

Where the soldiers mocked Jesus (27:27).

◆ Factbook: Praetorium

Golgotha (traditional) VIDEO

'A place called Golgotha, which means Place of a Skull' (27:33).

◆ Factbook: Golgotha

08

Key terms

Golgotha

VIDEO

Aramaic for 'Place of a Skull,' outside Jerusalem's wall.

◆ Factbook: Golgotha

Remez

VIDEO

A hint: quoting part of a passage to call the whole to mind.

Day of Preparation

VIDEO

The day before the Sabbath, that is, Friday.

◆ Factbook: Sabbath ◆ Factbook: Day of Preparation

Veil

VIDEO

The curtain in the sanctuary; the inner one screened the holy of holies.

◆ Factbook: Veil of the temple

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ἀργύριον

argyrion G694

Silver; a silver coin.

Greek · Matt 27:5

◆ Factbook: Thirty pieces of silver

Βαραββᾶς

Barabbas G912

Barabbas, Aramaic 'son of the father.'

Greek · Matt 27:16

◆ Factbook: Barabbas

Γολγοθᾶ

Golgotha G1115

Golgotha, 'skull.'

Greek · Matt 27:33

◆ Factbook: Golgotha

χολή

cholē G5521

Gall, a bitter substance.

Greek · Matt 27:34

ἐγκαταλείπω

enkataleipō G1459

To forsake, abandon.

Greek · Matt 27:46

καταπέτασμα

katapetasma G2665

Veil, curtain.

Greek · Matt 27:51

◆ Factbook: Veil of the temple

παρασκευή

paraskeuē G3904

Preparation; the day before the Sabbath.

Greek · Matt 27:62

◆ Factbook: Day of Preparation

יוֹצֵר

yotser H3335

To form; as a noun, potter.

Hebrew · Zech 11:13

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Roman crucifixion

Rome reserved crucifixion for slaves, rebels and the worst criminals. Scourging came first; the condemned often carried the crossbeam, and a placard named the charge.

The governor at Passover

Pilate normally lived in Caesarea and came to Jerusalem at the feasts to keep order. A stone found at Caesarea in 1961 names him prefect of Judea.

Rock-cut tombs

Wealthy families cut tombs into the rock, closed with a large stone. Burial had to happen before the Sabbath began at sunset.

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *"This cry rent the veil, and opened the tombs, and made the house desolate.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 88, on 27:50-51. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"Eighty and six years have I served Him, and He never did me any injury: how then can I blaspheme my King and my Saviour?*
>
> Martyrdom of Polycarp, c. AD 156. Martyrdom of Polycarp 9. ANF 1 (public domain). The video names Polycarp as one who died well.

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Which veil was torn?

Most think the inner veil before the holy of holies (Hebrews 10:19-20); some the outer curtain, visible to all. The video leaves it open.

The raised saints

Some read 27:52-53 as a literal event; others as apocalyptic imagery woven into the narrative. The video says it is still weighing this.

Forsaken?

Many hold that the Son bore the Father's judgment and in that sense was forsaken. The video stresses that the cry points to the whole psalm, which ends in God's answer (Psalm 22:21, 24).

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- Caiaphas asked whether Jesus is 'the Christ, the Son of God' (26:63); 'King of the Jews' is Pilate's question (27:11).
- 'His blood be on us' is Matthew 27:25, not 27:2.
- The burial is 27:57-61 and the guard 27:62-66; the video gives verses 55 to 60.
- 'Jesus Barabbas' appears in only some manuscripts of 27:16-17; most English Bibles, including the LSB, read 'Barabbas.'

11 · BACKGROUND

From David to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 27 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1000 BC DEBATED

David: My God, my God
Psalm 22:1 *Echoed: 27:46*

C. 700 BC DEBATED
Isaiah: with a rich man in His death
Isaiah 53:9 *Echoed: 27:57-60*

C. 600 BC DEBATED
Jeremiah's potter's jar
Jeremiah 19:1

C. 520 BC DEBATED
Zechariah: thirty shekels
Zechariah 11:13 *Echoed: 27:9-10*

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The crucifixion and burial
Matthew 27:1-66 *This episode*

C. AD 156
Polycarp dies well
Matthew 27:50

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: this cry rent the veil
Matthew 27:51

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Acts 7:59-60
Stephen dies praying
ADDED

Hebrews 10:19-20
Through the veil, His flesh
ADDED

Acts 1:18-19
The Field of Blood
ADDED

Philippians 2:8
Obedient to the point of death
ADDED

2 Timothy 4:6-8
Paul faces death
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1. What might Matthew be implying with the triad of Judas, Pilate and the crowd?
2. Why did the leaders refuse the blood money but not the plot?
3. How does reading all of Psalm 22 change how you hear 'My God, My God'?
4. Which veil do you think was torn, and what difference does it make?
5. How did Stephen, Peter and Polycarp show they had learned from Jesus how to die?
6. What would it look like for you to be so filled with God's word that it flows out at the end?

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The cross first means that Jesus bore our sins in His body (1 Peter 2:24); we never outgrow justification and atonement. But there is a lesson for disciples too: set free from the law of sin and of death (Romans 8:2), the apostles were also free to die, and Stephen, Peter and Polycarp died on their Savior's model. Death, like suffering, is appointed by God for a purpose. The lesson: dying is the final act of obedience that a person can perform unto God, and the one who is filled with the word of God will glorify God in their final act of obedience. God did not forsake Jesus, and He will not forsake His people.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

read Psalm 22 aloud this week, and choose one verse from its second half to memorize.

> *"Dying is the final act of obedience that a person can perform unto God. And the one who is filled with the word of God will glorify God in their final act of obedience.*
>
> From the video

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Isaiah ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Judgment ◆ Pentecost
◆ Righteousness ◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ Book of Deuteronomy
◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship ◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet)
◆ Gentiles ◆ Healing ◆ Hypocrite ◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Judea ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Prayer
◆ Book of Proverbs ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Blasphemy ◆ Centurion ◆ Joel (the prophet) ◆ Paul
◆ Priest ◆ Apostle ◆ Caesarea Maritima ◆ Judas Iscariot ◆ Messiah ◆ Stephen (martyr) ◆ Sabbath
◆ Passover ◆ Elder ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Resurrection ◆ Barabbas ◆ Caiaphas ◆ Crucifixion
◆ Day of Preparation ◆ Akeldama (Field of Blood) ◆ Golgotha ◆ Holy of holies ◆ Joseph of Arimathea
◆ Myrrh ◆ Pontius Pilate ◆ Polycarp ◆ Praetorium ◆ Simon of Cyrene ◆ Thirty pieces of silver
◆ Veil of the temple

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers; Martyrdom of Polycarp: Ante-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (Antonio Ciseri; James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.